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ATTRACTION: Ruins of Vikramshila University

ALTERNATIVE NAMES:

Vikramshila

LOCATION:

Bhagalpur

DISTRICT / REGION:

Bhagalpur

CATEGORY:

Historical Site / Heritage Site

OVERVIEW:

The Ruins of Vikramshila University form an incredible historical site in Bhagalpur, representing one of ancient India's most significant centers of learning. Founded by the Pala King Dharmapala, the university thrived between the 9th to 13th centuries CE as a bustling education center for a large number of teachers and students.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION:

Excavations at the site have unearthed massive and structurally complex ruins. At the center lies a colossal square remnant of a double-storeyed stupa featuring a cruciform structure. The site also includes the remains of an ancient library and an array of votive stupas. In addition to Buddhist structures, a Tibetan and a Hindu temple have also been discovered. During its peak, the university taught a wide variety of subjects including Philosophy, Theology, Metaphysics, Grammar, Logic, and Tantrism.

HISTORICAL OR CULTURAL SIGNIFICANCE:

Alongside Nalanda, Vikramshila was a premier institution of higher learning in ancient India. It played a pivotal role in the spread of Buddhist teachings, particularly Tantrism and Vajrayana Buddhism, across Asia, including Tibet. The Bhagalpur region itself is deeply historical, being one of the oldest districts, historically renowned as the 'Silk City' for its high-quality tussar silk fabric.

LEGENDS, STORIES, OR TRADITIONS:

Not Mentioned

KEY HIGHLIGHTS:

- Founded by the Pala King Dharmapala.
- Thrived between 9th to 13th century CE.
- Colossal square double-storeyed stupa with a cruciform structure.
- Remains of a library and votive stupas.
- Discovery of Tibetan and Hindu temples.

VISITOR INFORMATION:

Best Time To Visit:

Not Mentioned

Opening Hours:

Not Mentioned

Entry Fee:

Not Mentioned

Duration Recommended:

Not Mentioned

Photography:

Not Mentioned

Accessibility Information:

Not Mentioned

FACILITIES:

Not Mentioned

TRANSPORTATION:

Nearest Airport:

Jay Prakash Narayan International Airport, (Patna)

Distance From Airport:

Not Mentioned

Nearest Railway Station:

Bhagalpur Railway Station

Distance From Railway Station:

Not Mentioned

Nearest Bus Stand:

Not Mentioned

Distance From Bus Stand:

Not Mentioned

Road Connectivity:

Bhagalpur is well connected by road. Bus and Taxi Services can be used to reach here.

Nearest Tourist Information Centre:

Not Mentioned

Nearest Police Station:

Not Mentioned

Nearest Medical Facility:

Not Mentioned

NEARBY ATTRACTIONS:

Not Mentioned

FESTIVALS AND EVENTS:

Not Mentioned

LOCAL CULTURE AND EXPERIENCES:

Bhagalpur is famous for the production of excellent quality tussar silk fabric and its mango and litchi groves due to the alluvial soil of the plains.

LOCAL FOOD AND CUISINE:

Not Mentioned

SHOPPING AND SOUVENIRS:

Tussar silk fabric (from Bhagalpur, historically known as the 'Silk City').

ACCOMMODATION:

Not Mentioned

HOTELS:

Not Mentioned

LOCAL GUIDES:

Not Mentioned

TRAVEL OPERATORS:

Not Mentioned

IMPORTANT FACTS:

- Taught Philosophy, Theology, Metaphysics, Grammar, Logic, and Tantrism.

RETRIEVAL SUMMARY:

The Ruins of Vikramshila University in Bhagalpur represent a bustling 9th-13th century CE education center founded by Pala King Dharmapala. The site features a colossal cruciform double-storeyed stupa, a library, votive stupas, and Tibetan/Hindu temples. It taught subjects like Philosophy and Tantrism. Accessible via Patna Airport and Bhagalpur Railway Station, the region is also famous for Tussar silk.

QUESTION-ANSWER FACTS:

Q: What is this attraction known for?

A: It is known as the ruins of an ancient university founded by the Pala King Dharmapala, thriving from the 9th to 13th centuries CE.

Q: Where is it located?

A: It is located in Bhagalpur.

Q: What structural remains have been found here?

A: A colossal double-storeyed cruciform stupa, a library, votive stupas, and Tibetan and Hindu temples.

Q: What subjects were taught at Vikramshila?

A: Subjects included Philosophy, Theology, Metaphysics, Grammar, Logic, and Tantrism.

Q: How can visitors reach it?

A: By air to Patna or by train to Bhagalpur Railway Station, connected by road.

KEYWORDS:

Ruins of Vikramshila University, Bhagalpur, Pala King Dharmapala, 9th to 13th Century, Cruciform Stupa, Tantrism, Education Centre, Silk City, Tussar Silk, Buddhist Circuit.

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